

FDE Layer: Narrative, Behavioral, Questions

The code is the easy part of a final round. This decides it. Fill the [brackets] with YOUR real stories before the call.

30-SECOND OPENING

"Enterprise marketing teams need hundreds of on-brand creative variants per campaign, and doing it by hand is too slow and too expensive. I built a six-step pipeline: a campaign brief in YAML or JSON goes in, and compliance-checked creatives come out. It loads and validates the brief, gathers or generates each product image, renders three aspect ratios, applies the brand overlay, organizes the outputs, then runs compliance. Every step has a typed Zod contract, every Claude call logs tokens and cost, and the whole thing is a deliberate two-to-three hour POC, so I scoped auth, queuing, and multi-tenancy out on purpose and documented them. Happy to go deep wherever you want." *Then stop talking. Let them steer.*

BEHAVIORAL, FRAMED FOR FDE

Why move from building product to a customer-facing FDE role? Why Adobe?

Testing: do you actually want this job, or is it a fallback.

[Your real reason.] Anchor: "I like owning the line from a customer's messy requirement to a shipped technical answer. This POC is that instinct, I turned a vague 'we need variants at scale' into a concrete contract-driven pipeline. Adobe is where creative tooling and GenAI actually meet at enterprise scale, so the customer problems are real and the platform is deep."

Tell me about ambiguous or shifting requirements.

Testing: do you scope, or do you boil the ocean.

[Your story.] POC anchor: "The brief format wasn't given, so I defined the contract myself with Zod and made the schema the single source of truth. When reuse-vs-generate was unclear, I built one field, `existingAssetPath`, with an explicit fallback to generation. I picked the 80% path and documented the rest as deferred."

A technical tradeoff under time pressure.

Testing: can you decide and defend, not just list options.

POC anchors, pick one: (1) polling over SSE because the Replit proxy buffers chunks, simplest thing that survived the environment. (2) deterministic compliance gates (color, legal words) as the trusted checks, vision logo check as advisory, because I won't gate a release on a non-deterministic call. (3) failure isolation in compliance but not yet in generation, a conscious POC scope cut I can name out loud.

A customer wants something the product can't do, or shouldn't.

Testing: do you push back well and offer a path.

[Your story.] Stance: "I separate the underlying need from the asked-for feature, confirm the need, then offer the closest supported path plus the cost of the bespoke one. I'd rather ship the 90% they can use today than promise the 100% that slips."

Disagreeing with a stakeholder or teammate.

Testing: can you hold a position without being difficult.

[Your story.] Anchor on evidence: "I make the disagreement concrete and testable, then defer to data. In this POC, if someone said 'just trust the vision check,' I'd show that it has no seed and no temperature pin, so it flips between runs, and propose pinning it before we rely on it."

FDE TALK-TRACK REMINDERS

- Lead with the **customer problem**, not the tech. Every answer ties back to "what does the marketing team get."
- **Name your scope cuts before they do.** "I deferred X on purpose" reads as senior. Getting caught reads as junior.
- Make tradeoffs **explicit and reversible**: "I chose A over B because C, and here's when I'd revisit."
- Show your **observability**: typed contracts, structured logs, a cost ledger. FDEs are trusted in prod, so prove you can see what's happening.
- When you don't know, say so, then say how you'd find out. Confidence, not bluffing.

ASK THEM (PICK 2-3) END STRONG

- "When an FDE drops into a customer, how much is greenfield building vs. integrating into the customer's existing Adobe stack?"
- "Where does the FDE handoff to the product or core engineering team usually happen, and what makes that handoff go badly?"
- "What separates an FDE who's thriving here at one year from one who's struggling?"
- "How much of the role is GenAI solutioning today vs. classic integration work, and where is that mix heading?"
- "What's a customer problem your team is fighting right now that you wish was already solved?"